ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 3 · PRACTICE B · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 60

Marking guideline for the Academic Central Grade 8 English First Additional Language paper 3 · practice b.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education marking guideline.

How to mark: Writing is marked with the rubrics below, not with ticks. Read the whole piece first, then decide on the level for each criterion. Learners may interpret topics in their own way as long as the writing is relevant.

SECTION A: ESSAY – RUBRIC (30 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content and planning (18)	15–18: Original, mature ideas; fully on topic; vivid, well-chosen detail; strong introduction and conclusion	11–14: Relevant, well-developed ideas; good detail	8–10: Mostly relevant; some detail; ideas sometimes predictable	5–7: Ideas thin or repeated; parts not on topic	0–4: Hardly on topic; very few ideas
Language, style and editing (9)	8–9: Varied vocabulary, sentence types and figurative language; very few errors	6–7: Good vocabulary; few errors	5: Simple but clear; some errors	3–4: Limited vocabulary; many errors make reading hard	0–2: Errors make the meaning unclear
Structure (3)	3: Well-organised paragraphs with topic sentences; logical flow; correct length	2: Paragraphs mostly used; some ideas out of order		0–1: No paragraphs; disorganised; far too short or long	

1.1 **The day I was brave** – ONE event in which the writer (or narrator) faced a fear or did something difficult; build-up, a clear moment of courage (climax) and what was learnt. Feelings must be shown, not only told. [30]

1.2 **A busy taxi rank or market in the morning** – a description, not a story. Look for vivid sense images (sounds of hooters and vendors, smells of food and diesel, colours, movement), figurative language and a clear overall mood. [30]

1.3 **Community service** – a clear position; at least THREE reasons, each in its own paragraph with examples (e.g. builds empathy and skills, helps the community, looks good on a CV / takes time from studies, should be voluntary, transport and safety problems); a counter-argument for higher marks; a conclusion that restates the position. [30]

1.4 **"You learn more from your mistakes …"** – the writer explains the meaning (mistakes show what to change, build resilience; success can make us careless) and gives personal or other examples; reflective tone; may show a balanced view. [30]

1.5 The story MUST end with the given words. Credit a believable build-up (a message from a stranger: a scam, a fake prize, a dangerous link or a request to meet), suspense, and an ending that leads naturally to the final words. Deduct from Content if the ending is missing or changed. [30]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B: LONGER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (20 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (12)	10–12: All requirements of the task covered; correct format throughout; register (tone) suits the audience	8–9: Most requirements; format mostly correct	6–7: Some requirements; format partly correct	4–5: Few requirements; format mostly wrong	0–3: Task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (8)	7–8: Very few errors; suitable, varied vocabulary	5–6: Few errors	4: Some errors; meaning clear	2–3: Many errors	0–1: Meaning unclear

2.1 **Friendly letter** – Format: writer's address and date (top right); "Dear …" with the cousin's name; paragraphs; informal ending such as "Your cousin" or "Lots of love"; first name only. Content: at least THREE useful pieces of advice (e.g. timetable and classrooms, making friends, homework, dealing with older learners, asking teachers for help); warm, encouraging tone. [20]

2.2 **Dialogue** – Format: names of the speakers on the left followed by a colon; no quotation marks; stage directions in brackets; a short setting at the start. Content: the request, at least TWO reasons, the parent's concerns (cost, safety, homework) and a believable ending; natural, polite register. [20]

2.3 **Magazine article** – Format: the given title; by-line; an introduction that grabs attention; FIVE tips, possibly with sub-headings or numbering; a conclusion. Content: practical tips such as planning a study timetable, sleep, exercise, healthy food, breaks, past papers, talking to someone; friendly, lively register aimed at teenagers. [20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [20]

SECTION C: SHORTER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (10 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (6)	6: All information; correct, clear format	5: Most information; format correct	4: Some information missing	2–3: Much missing; poor format	0–1: Task not understood
Language, style and editing (4)	4: Almost no errors	3: Few errors	2: Some errors		0–1: Many errors

3.1 **Invitation** – who is invited; the event (Grade 8 prize-giving); date, time and venue; dress code if needed; RSVP with a date and contact details; name of the host (class or teacher). [10]

3.2 **Directions** – a starting point (the school gate); steps in the correct order; direction words (turn left, go straight, past the hall); landmarks; the end point (the library); short, clear sentences. [10]

3.3 **Message** – the teacher's name; polite greeting; a short, clear reason for the absence; a request for the work to catch up on; thanks and the learner's name; suitable, polite register (no slang). [10]

TOTAL SECTION C: [10]

TOTAL: 60

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE